PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

# Cosmetic Microneedling

The device maker's directions always come first. Times are typical.

**CHECK YOUR STATE FIRST ·** Many states, including California, bar estheticians from microneedling; others cap depth or require a medical director. Get it in writing from your board. Stay at or under [__ mm, per your state & device].

**DEVICE**
FDA-cleared pen only. Sealed, sterile, single-use cartridge for every client and every visit.

**CONSULT**
Intake, consent and Fitzpatrick done. No Accutane in 6 months. Retinoids off 5 days.

**INTERVAL**
4–6 weeks apart, never under 3. Series of 3–6. Prime deeper skin tones with daily SPF.

**SET UP FIRST** ☐ Pen in a fresh barrier sleeve ☐ Sealed cartridge ☐ Sharps container ☐ Gloves & sterile gauze ☐ Antiseptic & saline ☐ Approved glide

| # | STEP | TIME | HOW |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Review & photo** | 3–5 min | Confirm health changes. Stop for active acne, cold sore, infection or sunburn. Before photos. |
| 2 | **Cleanse & numb** | 2–30 min | Cleanse. Topical numbing only if your state allows it for estheticians; remove it completely. |
| 3 | **Antiseptic prep** | 2 min | Fresh gloves. Antiseptic over the whole area; let it dry. Hair covered. |
| 4 | **Open & set depth** | 1 min | Open the cartridge in front of the client. Set depth for each zone: shallower on the forehead and around the eyes. |
| 5 | **Treat** | 15–20 min | Thin layer of glide the device maker allows. Skin taut, pen upright, light pressure. Small sections, 2–3 crosshatch passes. Ease off over bone. |
| 6 | **Watch the endpoint** | — | Even pink to red. Cosmetic depth gives little or no pinpoint bleeding. Don't chase bleeding. |
| 7 | **Dispose** | 1 min | Cartridge straight into sharps. Never reuse. Discard the sleeve; disinfect the pen per the maker. |
| 8 | **Cleanse & calm** | 5 min | Saline gauze. Cool compress. Simple, sterile, fragrance-free soothing product only. |
| 9 | **Educate & rebook** | 3 min | Aftercare handout. Mineral SPF from tomorrow. Book 4–6 weeks out. |

**IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG**

· Heavy bleeding: stop, press with gauze.
· Hives or swelling: stop. 911 if breathing is affected.
· Pustules, oozing, fever later: refer to a physician.
· Needlestick to you: wash, follow your exposure plan.
· Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24–48 hours.

**RECORD FOR THIS TREATMENT**

| Device · cartridge lot | Depth by zone (mm) | Speed · passes | Glide · numbing used |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | | |
| **Endpoint · redness 0–3** | **Products after** | **Client comfort 0–10** | **Reaction · initials** |
| | | | |